

OVERVIEW

How can we turn “mistakes” or missteps into positive experiences when students are using math to understand the real world? Just as important as a mistake itself, is how we as teachers respond to it. In this conversation, you’ll have an opportunity to explore different ways to respond to “mistakes” and discuss how those responses might support or undermine your goals.

SPARK MEDIA & FOCUS LESSON

Animated Video

A teacher reacts to a student's incorrect answer, in the lesson [Hair Today, Gone Tomorrow](#).

PEDAGOGICAL THEME

Deepening Mathematical Understanding

USING THE CONVO GUIDE FOR A GREAT ROUNDTABLE DISCUSSION

- This conversation is designed for a group of 2-5 educators over 30-60 minutes.
- The Convo Guide serves as an agenda for a roundtable conversation where everyone is there both to learn and to share their expertise.
- Each participant should have their own copy of the Convo Guide and access to the Spark Media.
- Pace yourselves to get through the entire agenda in the time you have.
- Questions aren't intended to have a single right answer; instead, they're designed to spark rich discussions.
- At the end, everyone will commit to trying “one small thing” the very next day. Consider how you might follow up with one another!

OBSERVE

5-15 MIN

- To start, take a look at the Spark Media.
- What goals/intentions might a teacher have when responding to a "wrong" answer?
- What do you see happening in the animated scenario? What effects (positive and negative) do you anticipate the teacher's reaction will have on what happens next?

DISCUSS

10-15 MIN

- What else could the teacher have said and/or done in response to this student? How do you expect this would have played out differently?
- In what ways can a "wrong" answer support learning both for the student who gave it and for others?
- Beyond the immediate response, what other classroom practices communicate a teacher's expectations for mistakes and "wrong" answers? (Both intentional and unintended, explicit and implicit.)

RELATE

10-15 MIN

- Consider how you tend to respond when a student solves a problem incorrectly. How do you respond and why?
- Are there any ways you don't typically respond to "wrong" answers that you would like to try?
- How might you prepare your students for any shifts in classroom culture and expectations around "wrong" answers?

...AND COMMIT!

5-10 MIN

- What is one small thing you can do tomorrow in support of those shifts?